Foreword

The core idea of man-made objects demonstrating human-like intelligence dates back to ancient myths and is part of folklore. Ever since the term “Artificial Intelligence” was coined in 1956, this subject has attracted immense interest from within the scientific community, while also captivating the imaginations within science-fiction writers or movie-makers. Across the last two decades, the tremendous advancement of computing power, algorithms and availability of data has led to further development of AI as a subject. Over the years, AI has undergone periods of hype and skepticism, but there is absolutely no doubt that it will continue to evolve and influence diverse fields, promising both opportunities and challenges for the future.

Is AI going to make our lives easier? What are the associated security challenges? Is it ethical to disclose data? What are the social implications? These are some of the very valid points one must be aware of, irrespective of one’s background and area of operation. Healthcare, manufacturing, finance, education, retail – are just some of the sectors that are gearing up to adopt AI in various forms – mainly to boost productivity.

Overall, the future of mankind with AI is likely to be characterized by increased efficiency, innovation, and convenience, but also by the need for thoughtful regulation, ethical considerations, and societal adaptation. This book is perfectly timed and aims to create awareness and provide clarity around this subject. The content of the book is perfectly suited to impart sufficient knowledge to students and other readers with diverse backgrounds, so that they have basic familiarity with the key concepts in AI.

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